

History

History does not start with a beginning. It starts with a wound. Everything before it is simply gone. And so begins the story of Scyndos, with not a clear memory of what the land held before it split.

I. The Sundering (0 SY)

On the longest day of the year, mid-harvest celebration, the sky split - not a storm, not an eclipse, but a fracture, as though the heavens were glass under pressure. Rain fell upward. Plague and rot swept the lowlands. Prayers to every god went unanswered. The earth itself tore open, and where it tore, the Wound (also called the Fracture) remains to this day, a permanent scar across the land that served as a reminder of the cataclysm.

Maybe it was the prayer of a hundred beating hearts or the last wishes of a thousand dying souls, but an answer arrived. As the Fracture threatened to swallow everything, the Bearer, a being of immense, uncertain nature, anchored the remaining land and held it together, staying still on all fours until time itself enveloped their being in dust and memories. This brought the survivors roughly a century.

But it seems the curse returned to the land as resources were scarce and greed once again played its hand.

II. Aeon of Strife (0-100 SY)

A century of survival on scraps, held together by the Bearer's sacrifice. Resources dwindled. Old patterns of greed reasserted themselves among the survivors almost immediately: humanity didn't learn anything from the first fall.

III. Age of Veil (101-113 SY) - The Order of the Balance

After 101 years, when hope had effectively run out, a stranger arrived. Garbed in clothes of mourning, it was perhaps empathy that drew her to the fracture. She was blessed with magic to establish order to the chaos that ravished every corner of

Scyndos. Lighting the Everburning Candle, a flame that sits in the First Light and has never gone out since, she spent 12 years building a new frame for this broken land. And thus, as the Four Pillars rose under her command, the Order of Balance lit the dawn of a new world.

The first pillar brought identity - a ledger to record all names so nobody is forgotten.

The second pillar brought reverence - a faith to remember the Bearer's unending resolve to hold the land from drifting apart.

The third pillar brought coin - a concord to build back trade for all those who toiled for resources.

The fourth pillar brought survival - a guild to retrieve those who had been separated across the lands.

And when the fourth pillar was raised, and the dawn she had promised finally held steady in the sky, she left Scyndos and its people, with nothing but her light to remember her by.

IV. Age of Descent (114-128 SY) - The Corruption of the Pillars

Peace has a way of feeling permanent right up until it isn't. For twelve years, no one noticed the weight settling in.

Granaries that had fed whole districts for a decade ran dry within a single season, and the Concord, which once promised trade for all who toiled, now traded only with those who'd already learned to hoard. Villages went hungry for days while the rich never missed a meal.

Sickness followed scarcity, the way it always does. The Ledger, which once recorded every name so that no one would be forgotten, now recorded silence where the poor used to be. A family that couldn't pay the registration fee simply stopped existing on paper, and a person who doesn't exist on paper cannot be helped by anyone who only ever looks at paper.

The Guild, meant to retrieve the separated and the lost, began charging for the search. The existence of those who were lost and their fate depended on the coin families had. While the nobles reunited with long lost cousins, the poor were forced into a fate of being the last of their family line.

And the Faith, which had once knelt beside her at the lighting of the Everburning Candle, now spoke her name so rarely that the youngest generation of Scyndos had begun to doubt she'd ever been more than a story told to frightened children. The Bearer's stillness was reverence enough, they were told. The woman who bled to build the pillars protecting them did not need to be remembered to have done it.

By the fourteenth winter, the graves outnumbered the granaries. People who had nothing left to lose, the ones without names, without registry, without protection stopped waiting for a miracle and chose to seek her out instead.

Grace conferred twice often reduces its value. She agreed to intercede, but not freely this time. She cautioned them that peace bought once and squandered would not be given a second time without a price they would never forget. And so she asked for a barter, a trade of fate itself, freely offered by those willing to give up their own future for Scyndos'. Seven came forward, names history has never fully agreed upon, and gave what was asked of them, and order was restored a second time.

What followed felt, for a while, like the world made whole again. The Ledger recorded every name without favor, the granaries filled and fed everyone across the land, the Guild and the Concord performed their duties as they were intended to, and an entire generation grew up believing peace was simply how the world worked.

Order was restored. Peace washed over the lands, until one day the illusion broke into a thousand shards. After 12 long years during the week of the Harvest, rumors started to surface. Seven people across Scyndos had vanished without a trace. No note, no goodbyes. And thus began a cycle marking the Age of Dusk.

V. Age of Dusk (128 SY-present, 236 SY) - The Cycle

And so, the twelfth Harvest brought with it not just yield but also the anticipation of loss. People who went missing bore the title of The Called.

First Light, a city that served as a beacon of hope now housed a graveyard of the Called adjacent to the Silent Vale. No bodies lie beneath any of the markers; there was nothing to bury. Families who lose someone to the Call are marked with the Sigil of Nyr (oblivion) and bound by an enforced vow of silence, presumably to "prevent panic," though cynics suspect it's to prevent the pattern from ever being publicly proven.

The descent had begun over again. Corruption had sown its roots into the pillars that once protected the society. What served as lessons and warnings had turned into habits, with no stranger this time around to protect those who suffered. The only being that kept the land from crumbling was the Bearer.

An endless cycle. A defined fate. As the twelfth Harvest returns, so does the reckoning. The name has been written, waiting for you to take notice. This is the Call.
